

7 Steps for Disability Services Offices and Programs for Student with ID to Work Together

1. Consider the Mission Statements of both Disability Services and Programs for Students with ID

BOTH OFFICES

- Expect that each office and program may perform missions differently
- Understand similarities and differences to help define roles

DISABILITY SERVICES

- Provide equal access to all SWD

PROGRAMS FOR STUDENTS WITH ID

- Provide educational opportunities and support for SWID

2. Define Roles and Responsibilities of Each Office

BOTH OFFICES

- Determine who is responsible for providing each service or support to the student. A Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) can be a helpful tool in determining who is responsible for accommodations or supports
- Understand the differences between accommodations and modifications
- Work collaboratively to ensure students have access

DISABILITY SERVICES

- Arrange appropriate accommodations: Accommodations are supports and services provided to help a student access the general education curriculum and validly demonstrate learning

PROGRAMS FOR STUDENTS WITH ID

- Arrange appropriate modifications for audited, non-credit participation in course: Modifications are individualized changes made to the content and performance expectations for students

3. Talk Regularly to Each Other

BOTH OFFICES

- Maintain continuing regular and honest communication
- Assume the need to be flexible and adjust expectations when appropriate

DISABILITY SERVICES

- Discuss concerns with ID staff regarding provision of accommodations and supports for students

PROGRAMS FOR STUDENTS WITH ID

- Discuss concerns with DS staff regarding provision of modifications and supports for students

4. Include Faculty in Conversations About Classroom Accommodations

BOTH OFFICES

- Be able to describe the differences between providing accommodations for matriculated students and providing supports for students in ID programs
- Help faculty understand the differences in the programs and expectations from them for students with disabilities and students from ID programs
- Keep everyone in the loop

DISABILITY SERVICES

- Make sure faculty know whom to contact for assistance – accommodations may be DS, modifications may be ID

PROGRAMS FOR STUDENTS WITH ID

- Include the contact information for both DS and ID programs on any letters of introduction to faculty

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5. Collaborate with Staff in Student Services, Academic Affairs, Campus Security, Additional Departments	
BOTH OFFICES	
• Help staff understand the purpose of the ID program and how their roles and responsibilities impact working with students in the ID Program • Assure that students understand their responsibilities for follow through • Help staff understand to focus on the behaviors and not the labels	
DISABILITY SERVICES	PROGRAMS FOR STUDENTS WITH ID
• Work primarily with staff whose duties relate to accommodations	• Work primarily with staff whose duties relate to modifications

6. Be Mindful of Potential Problems or Concerns	
BOTH OFFICES	
• Realize that students with ID have many of the same issues and concerns as ALL students: fitting in, finding a boyfriend or girlfriend, planning a future, joining social activities • Notify each other of any inappropriate activities or behaviors, with student conduct or behavioral intervention teams to set expectations for behavior and working with students with ID • Support each other regarding the consequences of behaviors such as talking out in class, alcohol on campus, sexual assault, etc. Clarify student's accountability, and explain that he or she may be asked to leave if disruptive to campus environment	
DISABILITY SERVICES	PROGRAMS FOR STUDENTS WITH ID
• Explain same accountability and behavioral code of conduct expectations you would provide for any SWD	• Reinforce behavior and accountability code of conduct rules and expectations as needed for each student

7. Help Students Learn to be Self-Advocates	
BOTH OFFICES	
• Help students learn to speak up for what they want and to make decisions about their own life • Encourage the students to meet with faculty to express their classroom needs or concerns • Inspire students to be proud of their accomplishments	
DISABILITY SERVICES	PROGRAMS FOR STUDENTS WITH ID
• Encourage students to visit the DS office if they are not receiving accommodations as requested or need additional accommodations or assistive technology	• Remind students to notify program staff of any unresolved needs or struggles with day-to-day interactions with others, whether within the classroom or on the campus.